

Speaking the Same Language: Using Generative AI to Drive Discoverability within CRIS Profiles

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Artificial intelligence is increasingly shaping the way research information is surfaced, explored, and understood. Within Current Research Information Systems (CRIS), AI-driven approaches are opening new avenues for enhancing the discoverability and accessibility of research outputs.

In this session we will briefly overview the new AI-powered functionality introduced within Symplectic Elements and how it can be used to improve engagement with research within public profiles, making it easier for both specialists and non-specialists to assess the relevance of scholarly work at a glance. The move introduces AI-generated publication summaries, which offer concise, plain-language explanations of research outputs alongside key highlights and keywords. This opt-in functionality allows institutions to enhance the accessibility of their researchers' work while ensuring that individual scholars retain control over how AI-generated content is displayed on their profiles. By automatically generating digestible research summaries, this feature helps users - including potential collaborators, journalists, and members of the public - quickly grasp the significance of scholarly work without requiring in-depth subject expertise.

In addition to these advancements, an ongoing collaboration between Digital Science and the Ohio Innovation Exchange (OIEx) is further exploring the capabilities of AI-driven search to enhance the way users interact with data in CRIS-hosted public profiles. This exploratory initiative is investigating how AI-enhanced search can improve the discoverability of research outputs by making it easier for public users - particularly those in industry - to find relevant academic expertise, by integrating generative AI models to help users query public profiles data more intuitively.

An example use case: external industry groups may use a different selection of terminology to academia and researchers, making it difficult for potential partners to identify experts working in a given field, as they are effectively speaking different languages.

As Tim Cain of OIEx explains:

""From aviation pioneers Orville and Wilbur Wright to early aerospace trailblazers Neil Armstrong and John Glenn, Ohio has a longstanding and continuing connection with modern aviation and aerospace innovators and their work. As national, state, and industry investment in advanced air mobility technologies and manufacturing surges, several at the table in Ohio are exploring how to use the access to academic expertise and shareable assets that OIEx enables to more quickly identify, connect, and convene academic collaborators.

Not surprisingly, the vocabulary used by industry practitioners to describe these evolving specific technologies (e.g. vertiports, traffic management within low-altitude airspace,

guidance navigation and control systems, etc) differs from terms used in traditional academic works (e.g. mechanical, aerospace, integrated systems engineering). To optimise discovery through OIEx, we have been working on a taxonomy to enable better crosswalk and are working with Digital Science to explore the evolving capabilities of generative AI technologies to enhance discovery.”

By connecting AI to structured research data, this project aims to understand how well natural language search can interpret and respond to queries from public users, providing a more dynamic and accessible search experience.

This session will discuss how these new functionality and initiatives are exploring ways in which AI can be utilised to enhance the visibility and accessibility of research within CRIS systems and CRIS-powered public profiles. We will consider issues raised around accuracy, transparency, and institutional control in the adoption of AI-driven functionalities, and discuss what best practices around responsible use of AI might look like in order to ensure that AI serves as an enabler rather than a disruptor in the research discovery process.

This session is aimed at CRIS managers, research administrators, librarians, and technology specialists who are interested in the evolving role of AI in research information management. The discussion will provide insights into the potential applications of generative AI in CRIS systems, including lessons learned from the AI-powered features in Symplectic Elements and the ongoing OIEx project.

Attendees will take away a clearer understanding of how AI-driven enhancements can improve research discoverability, as well as practical considerations for integrating AI functionalities within CRIS environments. The session will also explore emerging best practices for ensuring that AI-generated outputs remain reliable, interpretable, and aligned with institutional policies. These insights will help institutions make informed decisions about the responsible adoption of AI in research information systems, ensuring that new technologies support rather than disrupt the scholarly communication landscape.